

Volume V

Issue IV

KGB PRESENTS

REVOLUTION

4W

Viva La
Revolution



An Editor's Guide to Crushing Students' Spirits

Allyn
Crushing on Freshmen

As an editor of this fine magazine, I spend a lot of time wading through incomprehensible drivel to guide it toward the pinnacle of our satire content: comprehensible drivel. It's a difficult job, one involving strategy and manipulation more so than artfulness or constructive collaboration. When I sit down across the desk from a young writer, I consider the words of the chess grandmaster Magnus Carlsen: "I am trying to beat the guy sitting across from me and trying to choose the moves that are most unpleasant for him and his style."

If you're a TA, this likely sounds familiar. Figuring out what to write in red pen to deliver a maximally crushing blow to a pathetic first-year is something that requires years of practice. So, I sat down with PhD candidate Mark Downapointe, a four-year veteran TA of 21-244, to collect his tips and tricks into a single informative interview.

"So first, you want to master what I call the 'demotivation sandwich,'" Mark told me. "You start by bitterly criticizing a tangible flaw in the student's work. For example, 'this proof is incomprehensible.' Then, you lift their spirits a bit with a compliment. 'You were born with a lot of talent' is a good one, more on that later. That opens the student up a little. Gives them a little self-confidence, which invites vulnerability. Then you ride that wave and follow it up with the second slice of bread. 'But I can tell you don't have what it takes to pursue a bachelor of science in mathematics.'"

Compliments aren't all the same though, Mark warns. You don't want to base your compliments off of the student's hard work. Instead, root all of your praise in fundamental attributes. "You don't want to leave personal growth in the equation. Your student should feel that they have a fixed domain of knowledge and skill outside of their own control. If they aren't succeeding, they need to believe it's an immutable flaw at the core of their very self. Sneaking this in through compliments, ideally from a young age, is how you build up that instinctual response to failure."

It also helps to know your enemy. Most CMU students were in the top few percent at their high schools. They never failed a class, and were likely on the honor roll. "Most kids that come here have never known academic failure. They've never had to confront inadequacy or recognize that learning is a muscle that must be trained. You want to maintain this at all costs. When they start missing lectures, failing exams, dropping letter grades, this needs to strip away the identity they've spent 12 years proudly building as an academic prodigy. Weaponize their sense of self."

I found Mark's refined techniques enlightening, despite his insistence that I am psychologically and constitutionally incapable of attaining his high level of skill. This article's first draft made its rounds among our editors, who loved his advice. One pulled me aside to tell me that while interviews have always been my strength, I just don't have the capacity to make it in the journalism industry. I hope that you too are able to find a use for the tips and tricks contained within this article.

Auntie Readme: Torn between my situationship and 47 feral hogs

Auntie Readme
Has a squealing feeling

Feeling Hogtied: February is the time for renegotiating leases. And, coincidentally, retreading and regretting my love life. I'm currently living in a two-bedroom with a guy who looks kind of like Timothee Chalamet if he were born and raised in the Texas panhandle. Long story short, we flirted a tiny bit, and he suggested that he was maybe considering possibly buying me flowers at some unspecific point in the future. Didn't happen.

I'm looking to find a new place to live, but all the good stuff got snatched up already. My only other option is a one-bedroom shack at the edge of Schenley Park. Now, this would almost certainly be preferable to awkwardly avoiding eye contact with my situationship every time one of us does the dishes or makes food, but the only hiccup is that I'd be sharing the place with the entire hog population of Carnegie Mellon University. What should I do?

Sincerely, Feeling Hogtied

Auntie Readme: Glad to hear from you, Feeling Hogtied.

Sounds like you've got quite the conundrum on your hands. Most pig-related species I know are enrolled in some Tepper degree, so I'd imagine the social life would be pretty great. On the other hand, hogs can get pretty loud, which is a pretty sharp contrast to the muffled weeping you probably hear late at night through the walls. I guess the question boils down to this: both situations will be annoying to handle, but only one of them will leave you feeling heartbroken. I'd recommend buying an air freshener for your shack, and maybe an extra big drip pan to catch the inevitable bacon grease.

SIGN NOW



Petition to sacrifice
the Bay Area to
Enlil, ruler of all
Mesopotamian
gods, to save
America from self
destruction.



Rejected Headlines #32

- Does the third amendment let me kick out my ROTC roommate?
- You think you're a leftist? I'm wearing Che Guevara!
- You can disassemble the military-industrial technocomplex after I get a job
- Why can't Israel and Pakistan just get along?
- ECEs flee to suburbs of computer science, citing too many civil engineers
- Nudist Revolution on Campus, 30% of campus disrobes
- ... and it's the ugly 30%
- OpenAI launches new Abacus; Calculator sales drop dramatically
- Transphobes: It's still Constantinople
- The Revolution is coming, just let me get off my SSRIs first
- For the upcoming Readme "Female" Issue: "Susan Be Shopping"
- Student Senate revolts after fourth straight week of tasty pizza at meetings

All this and more, not in this issue!

Auntie Readme: I want to get back with my ex!

Auntie Readme

She'll be coming 'round the mountain when she comes

Free Bird from DC: Hey Auntie, I think I've hit a rough patch in my life. It's February and all this talk of love and relationships has got me all torn up. See, it's been a rough year. I've just been feeling like shit. I keep blowing up at all my friends, friends I've been close with for decades! My deteriorating love life is certainly not helping.

Recently I've been thinking about my ex. What I see of her life seems so perfect! She broke up with that weird polycule she was a part of and started working on herself. She's completely changed her political compass and is focusing on her own self improvement. It reminds me so much of when we were together.

Now, I know we were far from perfect. I know people thought we were a crazy couple. I told her she was controlling and needed to get off my ass about paying the bills. She made me pay crazy rent, made me tolerate her weird friends, and she did burn all of my shit when we broke up, but nobody's perfect! People like to mention our age gap, she may be 1099 years old, but I'm 250, it's all legal! I dumped her (tea in the bay) because I thought I could do better, but now that I've amounted to nothing, I see I was wrong.

So, should I call her? I really think we could be something again.

Sincerely, Free Bird

Auntie: Thank you for writing, Free Bird.

It sounds like you're in quite the situation. To me, it sounds like you have some personal issue to work out before jumping into a relationship. Maybe try addressing some of those inner riots you feel. Then, maybe reconnect with this special someone as a friend. Build up a rapport before trying to pursue something more. Consider an exchange of goods, like jewelry or oil. As you get to know her better again, make sure you declare your independence and set your boundaries from the beginning. Maybe draw up some sort of constitution to establish the expectations of the relationship. Good luck, love!

This issue of readme is brought to you by:

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As always: Brought to you by the CMU KGB

See ya next time!

The Spinning Jenny is sapphic, actually.

House Plant

Yuri on Wheels

The story you've been told about the Spinning Jenny is a lie.

Years of queer erasure and the narratives of straight men have hidden the true lesbian love story that is the Spinning Jenny. While your history books tell you that it was a yarn-spinning device invented by James Hargreaves, this is a lie. The true inventor of Jenny? Why, Jenny, of course.

Jenny may have pretended to be careless when she dropped a spinning wheel on its side, but she was actually a mechanical genius, enabling the eight-spindled invention that would revolutionize the cotton industry.

When it came time to recruit mill workers, Jenny had a curious request: women should be the ones to operate the machines. Why? Because it takes a woman's eye, she reasoned, to understand the mystical anatomy of the Spinning Jenny. Men could not be expected to find the pressing wire.

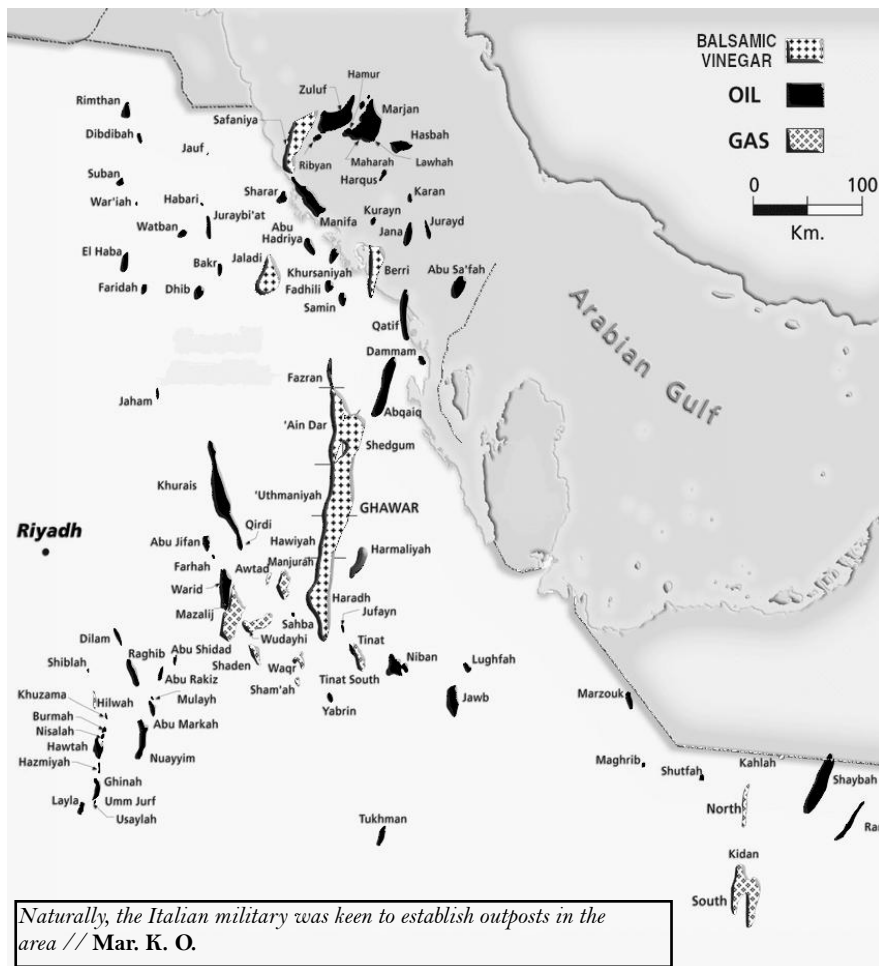
And so it was. Hundreds of mill girls came to work, coaxing the spindles around with a firm, gentle pressure. They'd run their hands along the threads, marvelling at the soft texture of the yarn, and slide

those middle and index fingers between the folds of the finished fabric to ensure their impeccable quality.

Soon, a camaraderie grew between the mill girls. Some women, especially close, would run the same machines together, hand in hand as they watched the spindles undulate. They'd stare deeply into each others' eyes as they worked and touch each others' hair to practice handling rovings. So often, they'd go home and show each other the benefits of increased finger dexterity, taking their new salaries and bidding farewell to their husbands before moving in together.

Men, so fed up with the sapphic paradise the Spinning Jenny had created, were quick to try and replace it. First came the Spinning Mule, because homophobes rather have bestiality than queer love. Then came the Slubbing Billy, to erase the achievements of women.

And Jenny? Many claim she didn't exist, that James Hargreaves had no wives or daughters with that name. They fail to consider that, perhaps, James was actually Jenny all along. As with Stonewall, there will always be trans women behind every revolution; The industrial one is no exception.



Top Secret: 2027 Chartwells Dining Concepts

Allyn
[REDACTED]

This confidential document was given to us by an insider within Chartwells, the division of Compass which provides food to colleges instead of prisons. Our staff has chosen to publish it unaltered.

2027 CARNEGIE MELL dining concepts

Confidential; no disclosure permitted

Concept 1: Water Chestnut

Proposed location: Cohon Center, 2nd Floor Marketplace

Salads featuring locally sourced greens and your choice of up to 2 toppings (wet or dry).

Concept 2: Marge's Pizza

Proposed location: Cohon Center, 2nd Floor Marketplace

Healthy pizza served cold by the slice with a variety of sauces.

Concept 3: H. Guyford Coffee Co.

Proposed location: Baker Hall

Drip coffee and international pastries in a grab-and-go format. Open daily from 8:30 AM to 11:00 AM (8:45 AM on weekends).

Concept 4: Hot Cross Buns

Proposed location: Posner Hall, in place of The Exchange

A variety of pre-warmed bleached flour buns, 2 per block. Cold water available upon request.

NOTE: Potential for increased margins for FY 2028 by uncrossing buns or reducing to 1 bun per block. Dependent on inflation, global supply trends. (Do not publish this paragraph)

Concept 5: Ciao Bella Express*

Proposed location: Cohon Center, 1st Floor

A pared-down selection of pastas and sauces.

* Is not actually faster than the current Ciao Bella, but gives you less food. (Do not publish the asterisk or this note)

Concept 6: Ham 'n' Cheese Deli

Proposed location: A Walkable 40 Minute Drive North of Campus

A family-owned-style establishment serving sub sandwiches, bagged chips, and a variety of bottled drinks. Conveniently located for busy students.



Join our
Discord



Survey Says!



CRYPTID CORNER

PRESENTED BY:
**ISABELLE
FLORENCE**



MEN IN BLACK

i apologize in advance, my shift key is broken.

not to be confused with the Hit 1997 moviE of the same name, oR thE 2002 moviE of the Same nAMe, or the 2012 movie of the same name, or the 2019 movie of the same name, or the lesser known animated series of, you GUESSED it, the same Name, men in Black are EIther goverNment aGents working overtime or something else completely. i guess categoRically all things fall undEr either government agentS or SomEthing else, but regarDless, buzzfeed unsolved supernaTural had an episOde for these guys, and that's enough for Me to write this biweeklY column about.

the general rumor goes tHat the mEn in bLack appear at sites that have experienceD ufo activity and interrogate witnesses. tHEy aLso have been known to Pressure ufo or otherwise supernatural researchers into subMission, but i rEally don't see any evidence of that. EXCLAMATION MARK

The false propagation of rumors about the government and its diligent workers is a serious issue. If the government has interfered in the lives of you or a loved one, it is only because they want what is best for you. The government loves you very much.

What's Your README Name?

[First] [Last]// [Title]

- 0 Farnam Jahanian
- 1 Your favorite prof
- 2 Your most attractive prof**
- 3 Your worst prof
- 4 Your favorite readme writer
- 5 One of your profs' mistresses*
- 6 Your favorite politician
- 7 Your first crush**
- 8 Your own name
- 9 One of your profs' spouses*

First name of...

Insert the last digit of
your mom's birth year
←

Insert the LAST letter of
your FIRST name
→

- 0 Farnam Jahanian
- 1 Your favorite prof
- 2 Your most attractive prof**
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- 6 Your favorite politician
- 7 Your first crush**
- 8 Your own name
- 9 One of your profs' spouses*

Last name of...

Insert the last digit of
your birth day
←

- A Aroace
- B Buggy fetishist
- C CS major
- D Drunk
- E English major
- F Farnam sympathizer
- G Gutless coward
- H Hates grass
- I Illiterate
- J Jehovah's Witness
- K KGB officer
- L Lockheed intern
- M Minor
- N Normal person
- O Obscure instrument player
- P Pilik drinker
- Q Queer
- R Rat bastard
- S Showed up once
- T Terrorist
- U Undercover cop
- V Violent trans antifa type
- W Welch resident
- X Can't fucking spell
- Y Yaoi addict
- Z Zohran fantasizer

Title

*if no spouse/mistress, choose someone to ship
**if you're aromantic, ship your friend